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GHQ FEC G-2 OPERATIONS SECTION

12 March 1947

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SUMMARY OF AVAILABLE INFORMATION ON FORMOSA (TAIWAN) UPRISING

1. Official Reports:

(a) AMILAT, Nanking, 76670, 9 Mar 47: Rioting reported in Taiwan Capitol of Taipei (Taihoku) with the city under Martial Law 1 and 2 Mar. Order was reported restored after a bloody 2-day reign of terror with substantial but undetermined number killed. The riot began when special police enforcing tobacco monopoly clashed with a crowd of several hundred people. Taiwan welcomed Chinese at first but Governor Chen-Yi has never been popular and relations have steadily grown worse with dissatisfaction over political conditions and forced Government monopoly over economic life. Gen Chen reported seeking to negotiate with Formosan leaders but Consul Gen reports revolt spreading throughout island and condition serious.

(b) ALUSNA, Nanking, 76929, 11 Mar 47: Consensus of opinion is that Formosa riots are due to mismanagement, bureaucratic monopolism and illegal property seizures of provincial government. Situation at Taipei still serious and the uprising is thought to be widespread. Government reports that the trouble had subsided are reliably reported false. Discontent is too extensive to permit forceful crushing. The majority of press is very concerned and opposes the present Formosa regime.

2. Unofficial:

(a) United Press, Shanghai, 2 Mar 47 (S & S): Announces Martial Law in Taipei (Taihoku), Capitol of Formosa due to serious Formosan uprising against the tightening of the government trade control monopoly. Mobs stormed police stations and reportedly several shots were fired. Rumors indicate Formosans are demanding United Nation trusteeship over the island which was returned to China after nearly 100 years of Japanese occupation.

(b) United Press, Shanghai, 4 Mar 47 (S & S): Reports news filtering through news blackout indicated uprisings had spread to south part of island while Governor Chen Yi sought to reach agreement with Formosan native leaders to end the bloodshed which, according to Chinese press sources, has cost between 3,000 and 4,000 lives. Approximately 20 Americans attached to the Consulate, U.S. Information Service and UNRRA are reported safe. Gunfire rattled off the walls of the U.S. Consulate compound in the center of Taipei where many persons reportedly took refuge. Revolt reportedly touched off when Chinese authorities clamping on increasingly rigid economic controls, conducted a search for smuggled cigarettes in violation of the Chinese State Monopoly.

(c) Associated Press, 10 Mar 47 (N. T.): Confusion prevails over all Taiwan. Chinese sources believe that the "passive resistance" of the Taiwanese against Chen Yi's efforts to improve matters was the result of a systematic

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planning by the Taiwanese. Sources also said the Taiwanese will avail themselves of the opportunity to demand independence. In Nanking, Generalissimo Chiang Kai-shek told Lin Yi-ching, Kuomintang member for Taiwan, that the KMT will adopt a "lenient", peaceful policy in seeking a rational solution of the incident.

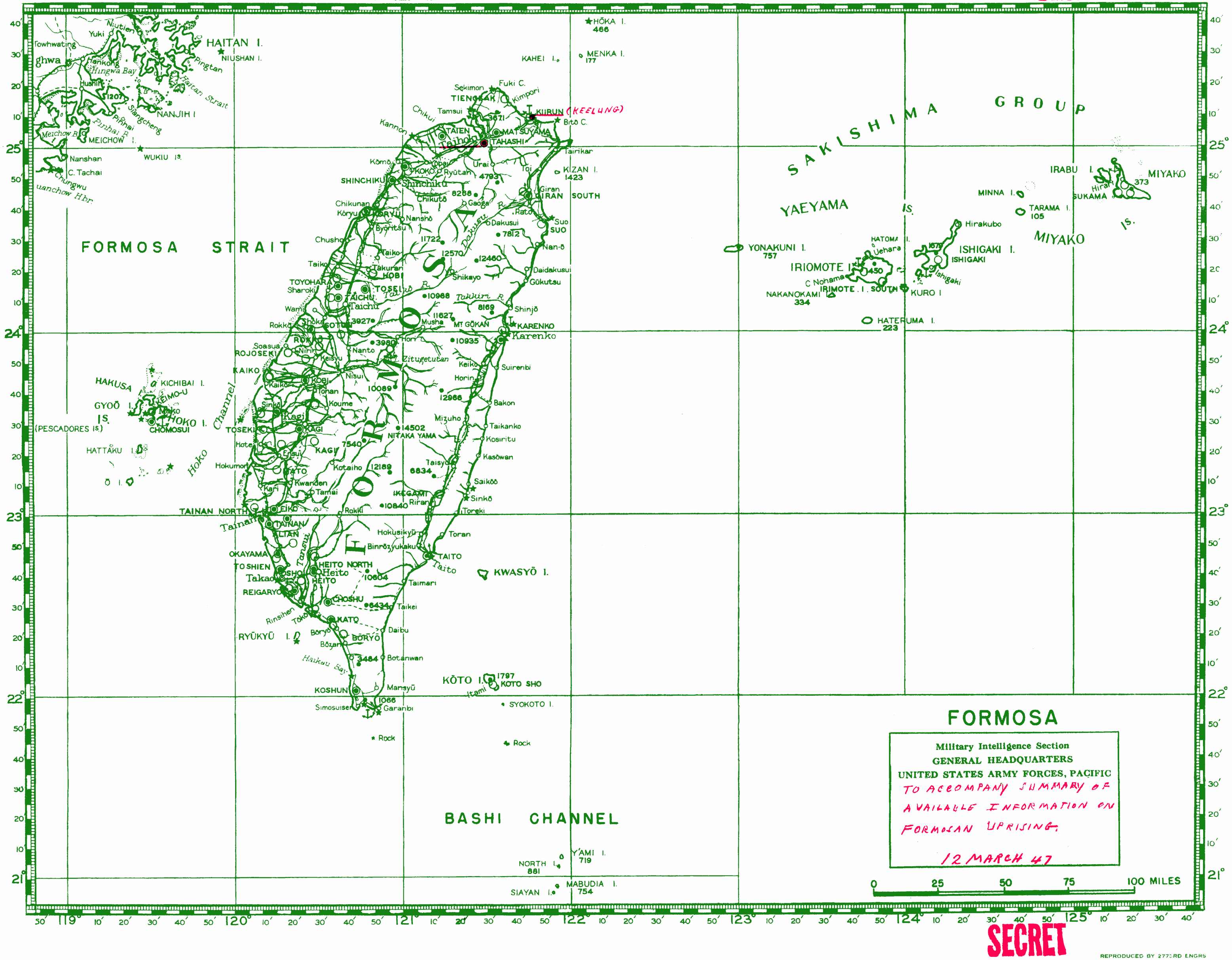
Mr. Lin stated that when he left Taiwan Mar 7, the Taiwan situation was already stabilized with highway and railway communications restored. Lin gave as reasons for the "unfortunate incident" a misunderstanding of Government monopolies rather than a planned rebellion against the Central Government authorities.

(d) FBIB Intercept, 6 Mar - Shanghai to Japan: Broadcast quoted Information Minister Peng Hsueh-pei as contributing the rioting to government control over small dealers in cigarettes. He stated the rioting started at Taihoku and spread to Takao and other districts, but claimed the situation is now under control. (This now officially reported false.) The broadcast further stated that about 100 Formosans and about 400 people of other provinces were killed in the rioting and that the control Yuan had dispatched officials to make an investigation.

(e) Associated Press, 11 Mar (S & S): Reported the Formosans demanding self-government a few hours after Chiang Kai-shek blamed the Formosans with communist inclinations and those who served with the Japanese expeditionary forces in the Pacific for motivating the unrest on the island. Formosan delegates in Nanking charged that 3,000 to 4,000 of their countrymen were killed in the rioting Feb 28, and said Chinese troops that day conducted a wholesale massacre that put to shame even the Japanese cruelty. The delegation said 6,000,000 Formosans had sworn to achieve self-government and said they would present 32 demands to the Chinese Government, including immediate self-government and severe punishment for Chen Yi and the Chinese soldiers who fired on Formosans during the riot. To date, appeals to Nanking had proved futile.

(f) United Press - 11 Mar (N.T.): Formosan revolt reached climax Sunday when they presented a demand to Chen Yi calling for the disarming of all Government forces in Formosa. Martial Law was extended to all of Formosa, all illegal organizations were ordered dissolved, all demonstrations and meetings were banned and required the registration of all arms in private possession. The Nationalist 21st Div has reportedly landed at Keelung, the main Formosan port on the northeastern tip of the island, while the 20th Div is expected to leave Shanghai soon. Government forces now on Formosa are estimated at 40,000. It was also disclosed that Shanghai-Formosa radio communications have been suspended since 1700 Sunday indicating the Formosans in renewed attacks have occupied radio installations. Unconfirmed reports said the demonstrators also seized the Bank of Formosa and emptied its vaults.

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FORMOSA

Military Intelligence Section
GENERAL HEADQUARTERS
UNITED STATES ARMY FORCES, PACIFIC

TO ACCOMPANY SUMMARY OF AVAILABLE INFORMATION ON FORMOSAN UPRISING.

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